

Phillip Smyth

Development Manager

07305 522 768 | phillipsmythwork@gmail.com | Liverpool, UK | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/smythphillip>

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Development Manager with 8 years of development experience owning delivery across complex software projects in fintech, supply chain, and SaaS. Maintaining my technical foundations, I continue to design personal projects from scratch, writing the specifications, documentation, and the codebase.

Across my career I have operated as both the primary technical authority and delivery lead on concurrent engagements, translating complex requirements into clear engineering plans, developing junior engineers, and keeping stakeholders aligned from scoping through to production.

I am a natural problem-solver who builds with the business requirement in mind, not just the spec, and I take equal pride in shipping great software and growing the people who build it.

Looking for a Development Manager role, where engineering depth and people leadership work together to build a high-performing team, own meaningful delivery, and keep growing my skills.

KEY COMPETENCIES

- Delivery Leadership:** Full Lifecycle Project Ownership, Risk & Dependency Management, Stakeholder & Client Management, Scope & Change Management
- People & Team Development:** Coaching & Structured Mentoring, Workload & Capacity Planning, Cross-Functional Coordination, Onboarding & Standards Setting
- Technical Authority:** Architecture & System Design, Technical Specification Writing, Agile / Scrum Delivery, CI/CD & Release Governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Development Manager at **Drive Further** April 2026 – Present

Development manager for a team of 5 developers, in an Agile AI assisted workflow using C#

Lead Software Engineer & Technical Lead at **Oddsphere** June 2025 – March 2026

Greenfield SaaS platform build. Sole technical and delivery lead across all workstreams from concept through to MVP, with no engineering management layer above.

- Owned full project delivery end-to-end: defined the architecture, database schema, and technical specification from scratch, then managed the build through to MVP launch across multiple concurrent workstreams, keeping delivery aligned with product and business requirements throughout.
- Managed workload planning, technical direction, and professional development for 2 junior engineers alongside coordination of 2 external contractors, maintaining delivery pace and quality simultaneously across a small, fast-moving team.
- Served as the sole stakeholder contact for all project decisions, owning all communication and sign-off with no management layer above, and ensuring transparency and alignment were maintained across the full lifecycle.
- Built and shipped the complete stack: backend API, Azure-hosted infrastructure, frontend, and UX, retaining hands-on technical ownership throughout to ensure quality and architectural integrity, and >90% code test coverage at every stage.

Software Engineer & Technical Lead at **Evoke Creative** April 2024 – June 2025

lead and primary client contact across 3 concurrent accounts, responsible for architecture, delivery, and team development simultaneously.

- Designed and delivered an NFC key encoding system and parking kiosk application from blank-page architecture to live deployment, integrating payment terminals, receipt printers, barcode scanners, and key encoders on a platform with no prior capability in this area. Owned every stage from technical scoping and client workshops through to production sign-off.
- Managed relationships and delivery across 3 active client accounts simultaneously, running requirements workshops, handling scope changes, and maintaining progress transparency with each stakeholder group while keeping all three engagements on schedule.
- Established code quality and documentation standards that reduced regression defects and improved release consistency, delivered through structured code review and coaching sessions with junior and mid-level engineers.

- Contributed to long-term product and architecture direction in collaboration with senior leadership, including strategic roadmap planning and key technical governance decisions.
- Led multiple projects as Technical Lead, managing a team of 8 developers and a QA tester.

Fundraiser Level 2 at **RNLI**

May 2023 – April 2024

Part-time | Liverpool, UK | Alongside personal development projects

While maintaining active .NET and C++ side project development.

- Led the fundraising effort as a Level 2 fundraiser, engaging members of the public across Liverpool with water safety messaging and volunteer recruitment, expanding the lifeboat service's community presence.
- Held Level 2 responsibility for training new fundraisers and upskilling existing team members, as well as scoping and testing new fundraising locations (Assessing public receptiveness), whilst maintaining results in the top 1% of the RNLI.
- Worked directly alongside operational lifeboat crews during launch scenarios, managing public safety, clearing access routes, and maintaining calm under pressure in live emergency contexts.

Software Engineer at **Korber Supply Chain UK**

August 2020 – April 2023

Delivered across enterprise supply chain systems within large multi-team programmes, contributing to architecture decisions and leading key delivery initiatives.

- Led the company-wide rebranding initiative as the primary responsible engineer, scoping the full effort, coordinating across multiple teams to minimise disruption to live systems, and delivering on schedule.
- Presented project status, risks, and technical decisions regularly to team leads, directors, and client stakeholders, and participated in architecture and design reviews at leadership level.
- Coordinated cross-team QA effort across multiple large-scale enterprise releases, owning high-complexity, high-load test scenarios under time pressure, whilst ensuring >80% test coverage across projects.
- Owned the version control and branching strategy across concurrent development streams, maintaining release integrity across a large distributed codebase.

Software Engineer at **MaxContact**

September 2019 – July 2020

- Led the application security improvement initiative from scoping and internal alignment through to production delivery, taking full ownership of a cross-cutting concern that required coordination across the team.
- Designed and delivered version control training workshops for new and existing engineers, taking ownership of onboarding standards and producing written guides and reference documentation.
- Coordinated QA handoffs and defect resolution through full regression cycles across dialler and IVR platforms, reducing handoff friction and improving cycle throughput.

Software Engineer at **Codethink**

August 2017 – September 2019

- Delivered across multiple simultaneous client engagements and open-source projects, picking up new languages, platforms, and problem domains quickly and managing competing priorities across workstreams.
- Contributed to internal tooling initiatives alongside client work, maintaining clear stakeholder communication and managing blockers proactively throughout.

IT Consultant at **BAE Systems**

April 2017 – July 2017

Completed a structured programme covering software delivery, ISTQB testing methodology, UX design, and cyber security. Awarded SC Clearance and ISTQB Foundation Certificate.

Lead Developer at **Start-Up, Hannover**

June 2016 – August 2016

Held full project and technical leadership for an early-stage start-up, running planning sessions, coordinating external contractors, and presenting demos and market research directly to investors.

TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

Actively maintained through hands-on delivery and personal projects to support technical decision-making, architecture governance, and meaningful engineering leadership.

Languages: C#, .NET (Core / 6 / 8), TypeScript, JavaScript, Python

Frontend: React, Svelte, Vue.js, Blazor, HTML / CSS

Cloud & DevOps: Azure (App Services, Blob Storage, Key Vault, Pipelines), AWS, Docker, Jenkins

Delivery: Agile / Scrum / Kanban, Azure DevOps, JIRA, Trello, CI/CD, Release Management

Architecture: Microservices, Event-driven systems, REST APIs, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST, Entity Framework

Quality: ISTQB Foundation, TDD, xUnit, NUnit, QA Coordination, Code Review Standards, Git

VOLUNTEERING

Team Lead at **Historia Normannis**

September 2017 – Present

- Led a team of approximately 30 people across Merseyside, delivering structured skills training, individual progression plans, and regular 1:1 mentoring. Multiple members have since progressed into senior and leadership positions within the organisation.
- Held regional leadership roles including Chief Logistics Officer and Inventory & QA Manager, authoring standard practice guides subsequently adopted across multiple other regions.
- Stepped back from direct leadership deliberately to create progression opportunities for those trained, demonstrating long-term investment in people development over personal role retention.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc Games Programming | University of Bolton | 2013 – 2016

ISTQB Foundation Certificate in Software Testing

City & Guilds Level 3 Software Development & ICT | CompTIA A+

Former SC Security Clearance (BAE Systems)